



MAGIC

In a magic square, the numbers in every row and column add up to the same amount – the “magic sum”. Look at the square on the right and see if you can work out the magic sum. Does it work for every row and column? Now try adding...

- the two diagonals
- the 4 numbers in any corner
- the 4 corner numbers
- the 4 centre numbers

In fact, there are 86 ways of picking 4 numbers that add to 34. This was the first magic square to be published in Europe, and it appeared in a painting in 1514. The artist even managed to include the year!

S Q U A R E S

16	3	2	13
5	10	11	8
9	6	7	12
4	15	14	1

The world's oldest

magic square was invented by the Chinese emperor Yu the Great 4000 years ago, using the numbers 1 to 9. To create this square yourself, write 1–9 in order, swap opposite corners, and squeeze the square into a diamond shape.

